



50 m/165 ft

WESTERN RED-CEDAR*Thuja plicata*
F: Cupressaceae

A large tree with flat sprays of small, scale-like leaves, this species grows in northwest N. America. Its wood is highly rot-resistant, even when dead.



70 m/230 ft

LAWSON CYPRESS*Chamaecyparis lawsoniana*
F: Cupressaceae

Like other cypresses, this has small cones and sprays of tiny, scale-like leaves. Originally from western N. America, it exists in many cultivated forms.

30 m
100 ft**JAPANESE CEDAR***Cryptomeria japonica*
F: Cupressaceae

A cypress rather than a true cedar, this tree has slender leaves and small, rounded cones. It grows on mountains in China and Japan.

20 m
65 ft**WESTERN JUNIPER***Juniperus occidentalis*
F: Cupressaceae

This long-lived tree grows on rocky mountain slopes in W. USA. Like other junipers, it produces seeds inside berry-like cones.



25 m/82 ft

CHINESE JUNIPER*Juniperus chinensis*
F: Cupressaceae

Widespread in temperate E. Asia, this shrub or small tree has prickly leaves when young, and scale-like leaves when mature.

linear leaves in
opposite ranks115 m
377 ft**COAST REDWOOD***Sequoia sempervirens*
F: Cupressaceae

Native to the coasts of N. California and Oregon, this is the world's tallest tree. Mature trees have a soaring trunk and relatively sparse branches, and can be as much as 2,000 years old.



95 m/312 ft

GIANT SEQUOIA*Sequoiadendron giganteum*
F: Cupressaceae

This Californian redwood is the world's most massive tree. The largest living specimen is estimated to weigh 2,000 tonnes, with fireproof bark over 60 cm (2 ft) thick.



40 m/130 ft

RIPENING
CONE**DAWN REDWOOD***Metasequoia glyptostroboides*
F: Cupressaceae

Native to C. China, this deciduous redwood is extremely rare in the wild. Until the 1940s it was thought to be extinct, being known only from fossils.



25 m/82 ft

MONTEREY CYPRESS*Cupressus macrocarpa*
F: Cupressaceae

Although widely cultivated, the wild Monterey cypress is restricted to a small region of California's coast. Mature trees typically have an irregular spreading shape.

aril turns red
when ripe

75 m/245 ft

TAIWANIA*Taiwania cryptomerioides*
F: Cupressaceae

One of Asia's largest conifers, this tropical species has a trunk up to 3 m (10 ft) thick. It has spiny-tipped leaves, and small, rounded cones.



40 m/130 ft

SWAMP CYPRESS*Taxodium distichum*
F: Cupressaceae

Also known as the bald cypress, this deciduous conifer grows in swamps in S.E. USA. Its trunk often has a buttressed base.



30 m/98 ft

CALIFORNIA NUTMEG*Torreya californica*
F: Taxaceae

This rare conifer is restricted to canyons and mountains in California. It is unrelated to the true nutmeg, although it has nut-like seeds.



20 m/66 ft

CHINESE PLUM-YEW*Cephalotaxus fortunei*
F: Taxaceae

This small, densely branched conifer has fleshy cones, which turn purple-brown when ripe. It grows in mountain forests in C. and E. China.



20 m/66 ft

EUROPEAN YEW*Taxus baccata*
F: Taxaceae

This long-lived tree produces seeds in fleshy arils – modified cone scales. Found wild in Europe and S.W. Asia, it is commonly planted.